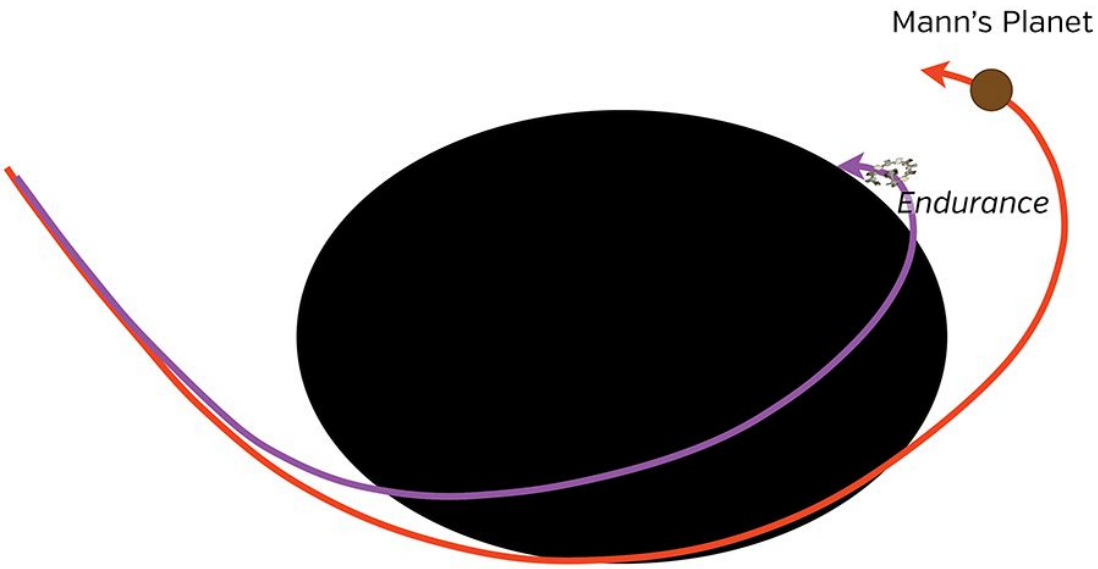


Fig. 27.2. The *Endurance* is pried away from Mann's planet by Gargantua's tidal forces. *[Image of the* Endurance *is from* Interstellar*.]*

The Critical Orbit and the Volcano Analogy

I discuss the critical orbit using a different type of picture than I've used before: Figure 27.3. I first describe this picture heuristically, and then I explain it in physicists' language.